Proposed Incident Risk Classification Matrix

Philippine Context

Important note: The Low–Moderate–High–Critical–Extreme scale below is a proposed operational risk-stratification framework. It is not an official five-level classification prescribed by Philippine law, the DILG, PCW, PNP, or DSWD. The examples and response actions are grounded in the cited Philippine laws and government guidance. Final legal classification should be made by the proper authorities.

Level	Risk Classification	Examples / Indicators	Possible Escalation	Suggested Action	Philippine Basis / Links
1	LOW – Minor Incident	Verbal disagreement; isolated rude behavior; minor non-threatening conflict; minor policy violation.	Repeated conflict, harassment, bullying or disorder if behavior persists.	Document the incident; de-escalate; notify the appropriate supervisor/adviser when required; monitor for recurrence.	PCW VAW Desk DILG MC 2017-114
2	MODERATE – Concerning Behavior	Repeated unwanted messages; bullying/intimidation; stalking-like conduct; sexual remarks; escalating relationship/domestic dispute; non-imminent threats.	Harassment, gender-based sexual harassment, stalking, psychological violence or VAWC depending on facts and relationship.	Separate parties when appropriate; document promptly; preserve messages/CCTV/other evidence; refer to designated safeguarding, HR, VAW Desk or appropriate authority; reassess for escalation.	RA 9262 RA 11313 VAW Handbook
3	HIGH – Threat of Harm	Explicit threat to hurt someone; repeated stalking with threats; escalating intimate-partner violence; coercive control; serious sexual harassment; credible weapon-related threat.	Physical assault, serious injury, VAWC, sexual violence, or potentially life-threatening violence.	Prioritize victim safety; avoid forced confrontation or mediation in possible VAWC cases; preserve evidence; refer to Barangay VAW Desk/PNP Women and Children Protection Desk or other competent authority; consider protection-order mechanisms where applicable.	RA 9262 VAW Handbook DILG MC 2023-104
4	CRITICAL – Violence Occurring / Imminent	Physical assault; strangulation/choking; weapon displayed; forced confinement; severe beating; sexual assault; active pursuit of a victim; credible imminent threat to kill.	Serious physical injuries, attempted homicide/murder, sexual offenses, or other life-threatening violence.	Treat as an emergency. Contact 911/PNP and medical services as appropriate; move victims/bystanders to safety when feasible; avoid unnecessary confrontation; preserve the scene/evidence except where necessary to save life.	RA 9262 VAW Handbook PCW VAW Desk
5	EXTREME – Life-Threatening / Catastrophic	Shooting, stabbing, hostage situation, armed attack, severe violence causing unconsciousness, suspected attempted killing, death, or multiple casualties.	Attempted or consummated homicide/murder or other grave offenses, subject to investigation and legal determination.	Activate emergency response immediately: 911/PNP and ambulance/hospital; secure/isolate the area when safe; prioritize lifesaving actions; preserve evidence and notify competent institutional and government authorities.	RA 9262 VAW Handbook PCW VAW Desk

Reference Notes

Republic Act No. 9262 – Anti-Violence Against Women and Their Children Act of 2004: Defines VAWC to include physical, sexual, psychological and economic abuse, threats, assault, coercion, harassment and stalking; also sets duties of barangay officials and law enforcers.

Republic Act No. 11313 – Safe Spaces Act: Provides the legal basis for gender-based sexual harassment in streets/public spaces, online spaces, workplaces, and educational or training institutions.

Barangay VAW Desk Handbook – Philippine Commission on Women: Provides protocols for handling, documenting and referring VAW cases at barangay level and discusses immediate response and protection mechanisms.

DILG Memorandum Circular No. 2017-114: Provides guidance for monitoring VAW Desk functionality, including records, referral forms, service-provider directories and handling resources.

DILG Memorandum Circular No. 2023-104: Provides updated guidelines on the operationalization of Barangay VAW Desks.

Use limitation: This matrix is intended for triage, safeguarding, referral, incident-management and system-design purposes. It should not be used by non-authorities to conclusively determine whether homicide, murder, VAWC or another criminal offense has legally occurred.

https://pcw.gov.ph/assets/files/2019/04/Barangay-VAW-Desk-Handbook.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com